

> SIMPLE THINGS LIKE TALKING AFTER A FIGHT TO RESOLVE **A PROBLEM RATHER THAN PUTTING YOUR PARTNER THROUGH GUILT OR THE** SILENT TREATMENT CAN MAKE ALL THE DIFFERENCE"
>
> **– RUKAYYA ZIRAPUR**
> *Relationship coach, Indore*

depression—there is assistance in the shape of the modern-day dating coach.

Indian professionals addressing relationship issues are a breed entirely different from stuffy counsellors of the past. They often don't have formal offices, don't bat an eyelid if you list sex as your number one goal in a relationship and are experts at evaluating you according to your personality type—whether an extrovert or quietly empathetic, a people-pleaser or emotionally unavailable. Dating coaches seeking an approximate match for a client emphasise the communication of one's personality and emotional needs to a (would-be) partner. Unlike Sima Taparia of the Netflix reality show *Indian Matchmaking*, who pegs 'adjustment' as a mantra for successful marriages, our new-age coaches say emotionally mature interaction can obviate the pressure to compromise. As they put it, nobody can keep on sacrificing their needs and sensitivities.

"It is better to talk about your personality before it comes as a shock for someone with whom you've formed an attachment. Whoever you want to have a long-term relationship with, you need to be clear about who you are," says Radhika Mohta, a Bengaluru-based dating coach who caters to clients who are single. She doesn't think she helps people go on dates, but rather helps them connect with themselves first—"reverse dating" as she calls it. A matchmaking experience with her also includes personality grooming, how to set up a dating app profile, tips on what to wear and how to spot red flags. "I work on making people feel relaxed and comfortable on a date," says Mohta. A two-day course with her costs Rs 12,000 and while there is no guarantee of success, she says it helps people make better choices.

A CAREER OPTION

Bumble's 2023 Modern Love Report shows two ultimate goals, both polar opposites, people want out of relationships—casual dating and long-term commitment. But the path to these two teloses lies through a quagmire of anxiety, guilt, fear and confusion. "Finding love is like racing against a ticking bomb. I am worried that if I



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> **– YADHUVIR SINGH**
> *Men's dating coach, Delhi*